

Comps Team Contract/Term 2 Syllabus

As we move into the Spring term, your comps work becomes much more independent and driven by you. The goal is for you to take ownership of your projects and your comps experience.

The success of your group depends on the cooperation and professionalism of all of you. Some key aspects are:

- Participating fully (both in scheduled meetings and completing work outside of meetings)
- Acting professionally (e.g. communicating respectfully and timely with one another; abiding by academic honesty)
- Meeting responsibilities and accepting consequences

The purpose of this contract/syllabus is to lay out the expectations for how your group will work together, and discuss how you will handle conflicts before they happen.

After reading through this document and editing as needed, each member should initial each item and then sign the document at the end. I will then make copies for everyone. If you disagree with any of these rules, then you (as a group) should amend them. Any item noted with a [*] indicates an item that should be decided on in consultation with Amanda.

Primary Project Goals

1. At what point will you consider your project “complete”? (e.g. necessary to pass comps) [*]
 - Finished and polished poster and final paper
 - Simulations complete, discussion of results and established priors and likelihood ratios based on those simulations
 - Discussion on real-world applications and future directions, not just in regards to our project
2. What are your group’s “stretch goals”? (taken into consideration for earning distinction in comps) [*]
 - One stretch goal would be to apply our simulation to a different dataset, possibly one with fingerprint data, to better match the Busey methodology.
 - Shiny app, similar to that of Busey et al.

Note: the final decision on passing comps or receiving distinction is ultimately made by the math/stat faculty

Work Norms

1. We acknowledge that we are doing new things for which there is no “right” approach! It’s OK not to know an answer and we will foster an environment where we can ask questions about code, background literature, or statistical models without judgment
2. We all agree to work productively between **1** and **3** hours each week outside of our scheduled meetings
3. We will divide up work equitably. Everyone should contribute to the project and do a fair share of the work. It’s okay if some people contribute more to some parts of the project and the others during other parts. Part of working on a team is recognizing and using each person’s strengths. We will divide up tasks based on:
 - What is needed each time we meet. We plan on meeting twice a week next term for ~1.5 hours each, so we should be in pretty constant communication regarding what needs to be done for the project. Currently, we have leaned on Anu’s strength in R work, and Will and Ryan have been supplementing with literature research and writing.
4. We will agree on tasks and due dates in advance. We will track tasks and progress through: [*]
 - Weekly check-ins during our meetings
 - Constant communication over text/email
5. We will use a shared GitHub repository for all code, **Quarto** for our draft presentation and **Overleaf** for our paper. All code should be documented so others can run and edit it. We will promptly resolve all merge conflicts.
6. All figures and tables that appear in the presentation or paper will be verified by a second member of the group for accuracy.
7. If one or more team members are not doing their share of the work, [*]
 - a. We will involve Amanda when: this problem persists for weeks after it is pointed out, and with no communication or reasoning from the slacking member.
 - b. The team member will not pass comps when: The problem persists after an intervention from Amanda.
8. How will you use/not use AI? [*] (Note that all use of AI must be disclosed in the final paper)
 - We will not use AI to generate text from scratch for our final report, nor will we use it to generate any of our code from scratch
 - We have used AI in the past if we are very stuck on an error message or debugging problem in R and might utilize it in similar situations in the future.

Additionally, AI can be helpful in spotting small grammatical or spelling errors, which we also might utilize.

Meeting Norms

Our weekly meeting with Amanda is scheduled for:

Not set yet, but our top meeting times are:

- Friday 11am
- Monday 8:30am
- Wednesday 8:30am

Our weekly group meeting is scheduled for:

Not set yet, but we will most likely be setting it on a weekly basis due to scheduling difficulties.

1. We will show up to meetings with Amanda and group meetings on time and prepared
2. During meetings, we will give each other a chance to speak and we will not interrupt when someone else is speaking. If someone is dominating the conversation or someone is not participating, we will:
3. Before each meeting, we will: provide Amanda with a brief written progress report
4. If we will be late, we will: let the group know as soon as possible
5. If we must miss a meeting, we will: let the group know as soon as possible, with plans to follow-up or make-up work
6. If we miss meetings:
 - a. more than **2** times will receive an informal warning from the group
 - b. more than **4** times will receive a formal warning, notification to the department chair, and mandatory individual meeting with Amanda
 - c. more than **6** times will fail comps [*]
 - d. If extenuating circumstances (severe illness, family emergency, etc.) require extended absences, contact Amanda as soon as possible

Decision Making

1. Do you need consensus (100% approval of all team members) before making a decision about an analysis plan or modeling approach?
 - We will not need consensus, but we will discuss all decisions and ideas while being open to critiques or any changes.
2. What will you do if one of you fixates on a particular idea? (especially if it is not working out as expected)
 - Our plan is to converse openly and often about our ideas. We will maintain open minds throughout the process to try and limit the fixation on any non-working ideas. However, knowing this may happen, we will maintain accountability within our group through conversation.

Signatures

Will Schnepf
Ryan Chang
Anu Jajodia

Schedule of Work

Week 1

- Start methods section of paper, editing literature review section
- check-ins regarding simulation results

Week 2

- Editing methods section of paper, finalize literature review section
- Finalize simulation results, likelihood ratio and prior calculations

Week 3

- Start results section, finalize methods section of paper
- Finalize a clean github repo

Week 4

- Edit results section, start discussion, conclusion, introduction

Week 5:

- Monday: complete draft of presentation/poster due to Amanda

Week 6:

- Monday: complete draft of paper due to Amanda

Week 7:

- [TBD, likely Tuesday] final presentation/poster

Week 8:

- Monday: final paper due